Essential Summary

A Generalized Padé–Lindstedt–Poincaré Method for Predicting Homoclinic and Heteroclinic Bifurcations of Strongly Nonlinear Autonomous Oscillators

Zhenbo Li, Jiashi Tang

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1 Motivation and Problem Statement

Two major classes of methods exist for analyzing homoclinic/heteroclinic (H/H) orbits of the general oscillator:

$$\ddot{x} + g(x) = \varepsilon f(x, \dot{x}) \tag{1}$$

- **Perturbation-based methods** (HP, HLP, elliptic L–P, GHFP): accurate but require exact analytic solution of the unperturbed system, and involve heavy derivation and integration at each order. For high-order polynomial $g(x)$, these become intractable.
- **Padé-based methods**: no integration needed, but only work for $\varepsilon = 0$ (conservative limit). Cannot handle the damped case $\varepsilon \neq 0$.

This work proposes the **generalized Padé–Lindstedt–Poincaré (GPLP) method**: a synthesis that inherits the systematic perturbation framework of the L–P method but replaces every integration step with generalized Padé approximation. The result: a perturbation method requiring essentially no integration—each-order perturbation equation is solved by constructing a tailored generalized Padé approximant and matching coefficients.

2 The Generalized Padé Approximation (GPA)

The authors first generalize the classical Padé definition. In the GPA framework (Definition 2):

- The numerator and denominator of the approximant are extended from polynomial functions to series composed of any continuous function:

$$P(z) = \sum_{i=0}^{m} a_i\, g_i(z), \qquad g_i : \mathbb{C} \to \mathbb{C} \tag{2}$$

- An auxiliary operator $\Gamma(z)$ (any differentiable function or constant) is introduced:

$$f(z) - \Gamma(z)\frac{P_L(z)}{Q_M(z)} = O(z^{L+M+1}) \tag{3}$$

- The classical Padé and all known quasi-Padé variants become special cases of this definition.

This flexibility is key: different $g_i(z)$ can be chosen to match the geometric character of the solution—hyperbolic secant for homoclinic orbits (symmetric approach to a saddle), hyperbolic tangent for heteroclinic orbits (connection between two different saddles), and polynomial basis for intermediate-order corrections.

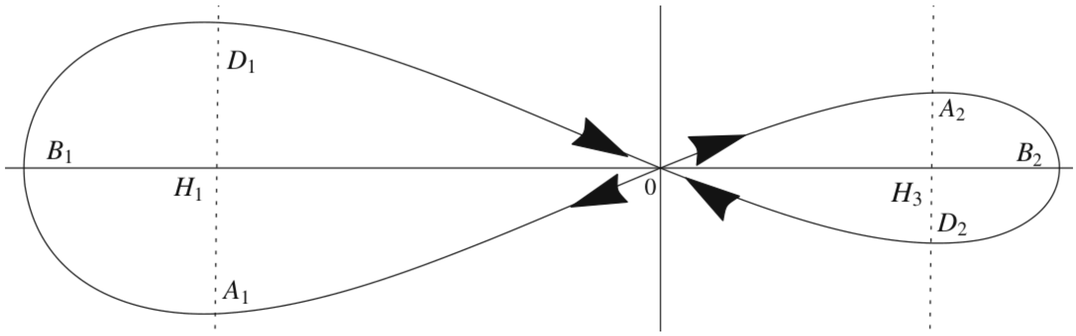

Figure 1: Potential energy curve and phase portraits of the Helmholtz–Duffing oscillator (66) at $\varepsilon = 0$. The cubic asymmetric potential yields two homoclinic orbits around the saddle point $H_2(0,0)$, symmetric about the x-axis but asymmetric about the $\dot{x}$-axis.

3 The GPLP Procedure (Four Steps)

The oscillator is expanded in standard perturbation form:

$$x = \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} \varepsilon^n x_n, \qquad \mu_c = \sum_{n=0}^{\infty} \varepsilon^n \mu_{cn} \tag{4}$$

yielding a hierarchy of perturbation equations. The GPLP method solves each without integration:

3.1 Step I: Zero-order x_0 (conservative orbit)

- Derive power series $x_0(t) = \sum a_i t^i$ from the conservative equation $\ddot{x}_0 + g(x_0) = 0$. Initial values: $a_1 = 0$, a_0 from
$$\int_{h_i}^{a_0} g(x)\,\mathrm{d}x = 0 \tag{5}$$
- **Homoclinic:** construct
$$\boxed{\mathrm{GPA}[L_0/M_0]x_0(t) = \frac{\sum_{i=0}^{L_0} \alpha_i \,\mathrm{Sech}^i t}{1 + \sum_{i=1}^{M_0} \beta_i \,\mathrm{Sech}^i t}} \tag{6}$$
Sech basis satisfies $x(\pm\infty) = h_i$, $\dot{x}(\pm\infty) = 0$.
- **Heteroclinic:** use $\mathrm{Tanh}^i t$ basis instead—satisfies $x(+\infty) = h_i$, $x(-\infty) = h_j$ $(i \neq j)$:
$$\boxed{\mathrm{GPA}[L_0/M_0]x_0(t) = \frac{\sum_{i=0}^{L_0} \alpha_i \,\mathrm{Tanh}^i t}{1 + \sum_{i=1}^{M_0} \beta_i \,\mathrm{Tanh}^i t}} \tag{7}$$
- Match Taylor coefficients between the power series and GPA expansion to determine α_i, β_i.

3.2 Step II: First-order x_1 and μ_{c0}

- Expand $x_1(t) = \sum b_i t^i$ with $b_0 = b_1 = 0$. Substitute into the ε^1 equation to get $b_i(\mu_{c0})$.
- Construct
$$\mathrm{GPA}[L_1/M_1]x_1(t) = \mathrm{Tanh}(t)\,\frac{\sum_{i=0}^{L_1} \eta_i t^i}{1 + \sum_{i=1}^{M_1} \xi_i t^i} \tag{8}$$
The Tanh prefactor enforces $x_1(\pm\infty) = 0$.
- Imposing $\lim_{t\to\pm\infty} x_1(t) = 0$ yields
$$\boxed{\eta_{L_1}(\mu_{c0}) = 0} \tag{9}$$
giving the **zero-order critical bifurcation parameter** μ_{c0}. This condition is equivalent to the classical Melnikov condition.

3.3 Step III: Second-order x_2 and d_0/d_1

Homoclinic: $d_1 = 0$, $\mu_{c1} = 0$. Heteroclinic: $d_0 = 0$, $\mu_{c1} = 0$. Construct

$$\text{GPA}[L_2/M_2]x_2(t) = \frac{\sum_{i=0}^{L_2} \lambda_i t^i}{1 + \sum_{i=1}^{M_2} \nu_i t^i} \tag{10}$$

The condition $\lambda_{L_2} = 0$ determines the initial value d_0 or d_1.

3.4 Step IV: Third-order x_3 and μ_{c2}

$$\text{GPA}[L_3/M_3]x_3(t) = \frac{\sum_{i=0}^{L_3} \sigma_i t^i}{1 + \sum_{i=1}^{M_3} \tau_i t^i}, \qquad r_0 = r_1 = 0 \tag{11}$$

$\sigma_{L_3}(\mu_{c2}) = 0$ yields the second-order correction to the bifurcation parameter.
Final assembled solution:

$$\boxed{x(t) = \sum_{i=0}^{3} \varepsilon^i \, \text{GPA}[L_i/M_i]x_i(t) + O(\varepsilon^4)} \tag{12}$$

$$\boxed{\mu_c = \mu_{c0} + \varepsilon^2 \mu_{c2} + O(\varepsilon^3)} \tag{13}$$

4 Why Three Different Approximant Types?

A critical design choice in GPLP is using different approximant forms for different orders:

- x_0 uses Sech/Tanh basis because these exactly respect the asymptotic boundary conditions of H/H orbits.
- x_1 uses a Tanh-prefixed polynomial form because $x_1(\pm\infty) = 0$—the Tanh prefactor enforces this automatically.
- x_2, x_3 use polynomial-based GPA because asymptotic conditions are already embedded in lower-order solutions.

The paper compares the mixed-form strategy against a single-form approach (Example 5), confirming that tailored forms yield substantially higher accuracy.

5 Applications: Four Oscillator Classes

5.1 1. Generalized Helmholtz–Duffing–Van der Pol Oscillator

Governing equation:

$$\ddot{x} + c_1 x + c_2 x^2 + c_3 x^3 = \varepsilon(\mu_c + \mu_1 x + \mu_2 x^2)\dot{x} \tag{14}$$

Example 1 (Eq. 66): $c_1 = -2$, $c_2 = 5$, $c_3 = 5$, $\mu_1 = 1$, $\mu_2 = 1$. Saddle point at $H_2(0, 0)$. Key results:

- **Zero-order GPA homoclinic solution** (GPA[4/4]):

$$\boxed{x_0(t) = \frac{0.0814\, S + 3.2534\, S^2 + 16.0572\, S^3 + 16.8002\, S^4}{1 + 14.2944\, S + 39.3405\, S^2 + 22.9087\, S^3 + 566.4437\, S^4}, \quad S = \text{Sech}\, t} \tag{15}$$

- **Critical bifurcation parameter:** $\mu_{c0} \approx -6.3941$.
- **Accuracy:** maintained at $\varepsilon = 2, 3$ (Fig. 2) and at $\varepsilon = 50, 60$ (Fig. 4).

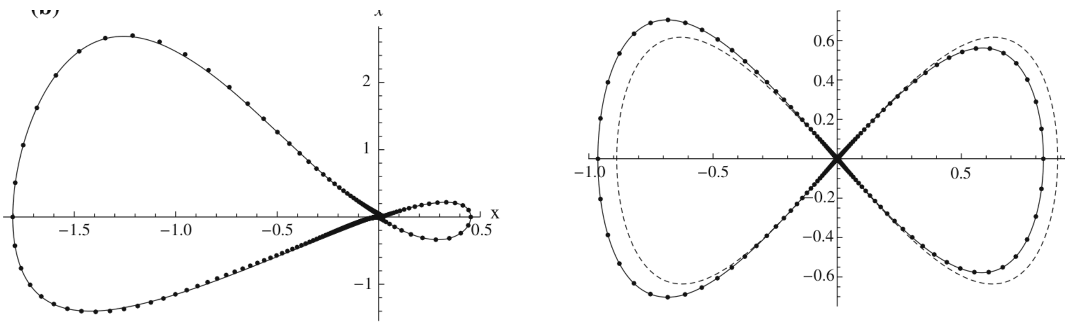

Figure 2: Homoclinic orbits of Eq. (66) for (a) $\varepsilon = 2$ and (b) $\varepsilon = 3$. Solid: Runge–Kutta. Dash-dot: GPLP (ε^3 expansion).

5.2 2. Duffing-Harmonic–Van der Pol Oscillator (Rational)

$$\ddot{x} + \frac{\lambda x + \eta x^3}{1 + \nu x^2} = \varepsilon(\mu_c + \mu_1 x + \mu_2 x^2)\dot{x} \tag{16}$$

With $\lambda = -5$, $\eta = 5$, $\nu = 5$: $\mu_{c0} = -1.9026$. GPLP handles rational $g(x)$ naturally—only the coefficients in the expansion change.

5.3 3. SD Oscillator (Irrational)

$$\ddot{x} + x\left(1 - \frac{1}{\sqrt{x^2 + \alpha^2}}\right) = \varepsilon(\mu_c + \mu_1 x + \mu_2 x^2)\dot{x} \tag{17}$$

GPLP predicts homoclinic orbits even at extremely large $\varepsilon = 50, 60$ (Fig. 4).

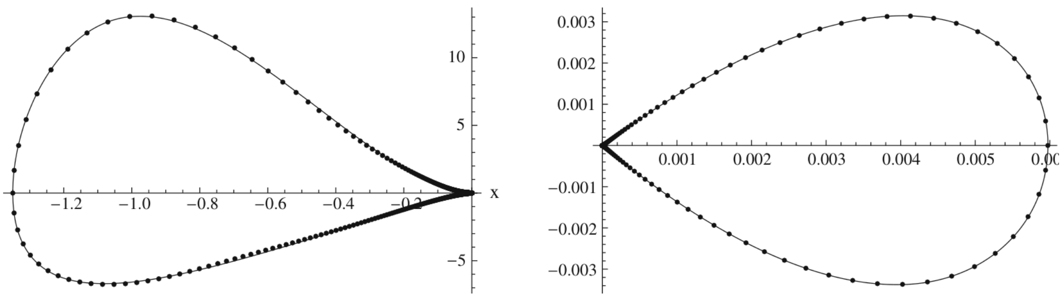

Figure 3: Homoclinic orbits of the SD oscillator at (a,b) $\varepsilon = 50$ and (c,d) $\varepsilon = 60$. Solid: Runge–Kutta. Dash-dot: GPLP.

5.4 4. Φ^6-Van der Pol Oscillator (Quintic)

$$\ddot{x} + c_1 x + c_3 x^3 + c_5 x^5 = \varepsilon(\mu_c + \mu_1 x + \mu_2 x^2)\dot{x} \tag{18}$$

The quintic potential creates a landscape where homoclinic and heteroclinic orbits coexist at the same saddle. GPLP predicts both critical values simultaneously.

6 Key Findings

1. **No-integration perturbation method:** Each perturbation equation is solved by GPA coefficient matching—no derivation or integration needed.
2. **Three tailored approximant types:** Sech-based (homoclinic), Tanh-based (heteroclinic), polynomial-based (intermediate orders).

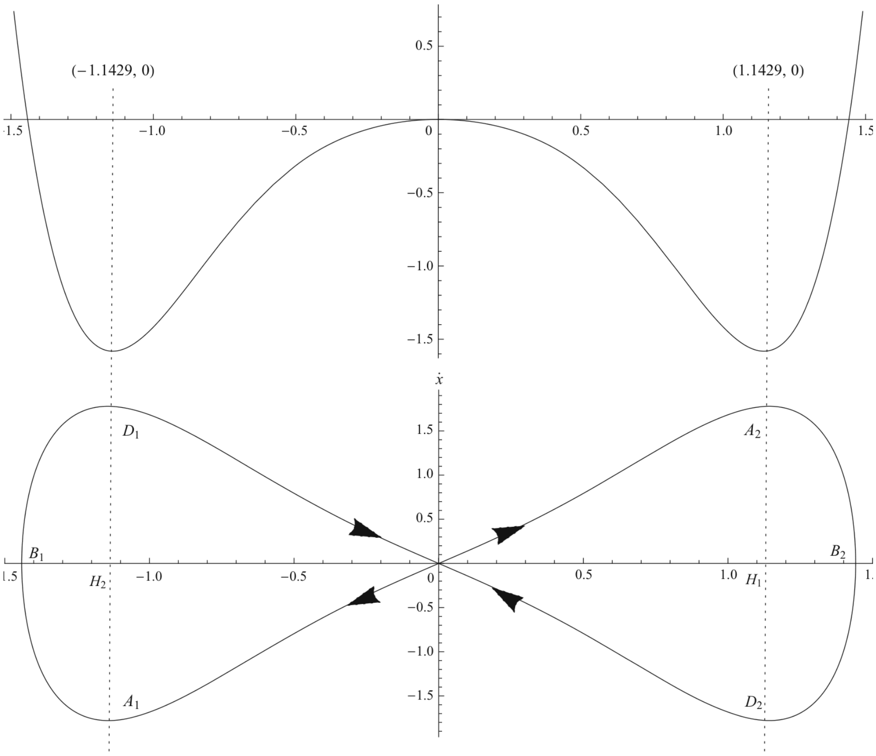

Figure 4: Potential energy curve and homoclinic orbits of the SD oscillator (112) with double-well structure.

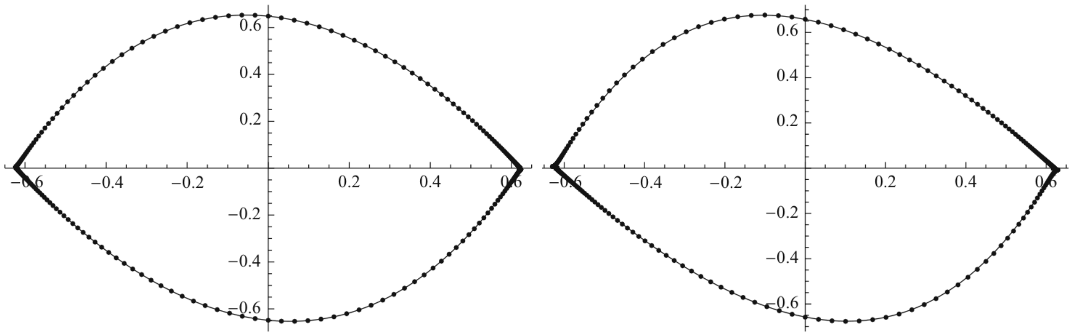

Figure 5: Heteroclinic orbits of the Φ^6-Van der Pol oscillator (102) for (a) $\varepsilon = 2$ and (b) $\varepsilon = 4$. Solid: Runge–Kutta. Dashed: GPLP.

3. **Universal applicability:** Validated on Helmholtz–Duffing (cubic), Φ^6 (quintic), Duffing-harmonic (rational), and SD (irrational) oscillators.

4. **Accuracy at large ε:** ε^3 solution accurate at $\varepsilon = 50$–60 because the zero-order GPA already closely matches the exact conservative orbit.

5. **Simultaneous H/H bifurcation prediction** in a single unified framework.

6. **Melnikov consistency:** $\eta_{L_1}(\mu_{c0}) = 0$ is equivalent to the classical Melnikov condition.

7 Method Limitations

- System parameters must be set before calculation (unlike algebraic methods such as GHFP).
- The approximation orders L_i, M_i must be manually chosen.
- Derivations at higher orders remain algebraically heavy even without integration.

Author: Zhenbo Li (lizhenbo@usc.edu.cn)
University of South China, School of Mathematics and Physics